MCP Tasks in Claude Code (beta, v2.1.304+): what the client actually does

Claude Code ships MCP Tasks. It uses less of the spec than you think.

1. tools/call

Claude Code sends tools/call to your MCP server.

2. Task object

Server answers at once with a task object: resultType "task", taskId, status "working", ttlMs, pollIntervalMs.

3. Poll loop

Claude Code polls tasks/get. Default every 2000 ms, clamped to 250-30000 ms. Backgrounded after 2 min by default.

4a. Done

status "completed": result returned to the agent.

4b. Needs input, interactive terminal

status "input_required" in an interactive terminal: user answers, client sends tasks/update.

4c. Needs input, headless run (FAILURE POINT)

status "input_required" in a headless run (claude -p): task CANCELLED.

Not used by Claude Code

Spec methods Claude Code does NOT use: tasks/list, tasks/result, notifications/tasks.

Rule

Build to what the client uses, not the spec.